4a. Option 1 - Create semantic model connections with Power BI desktop

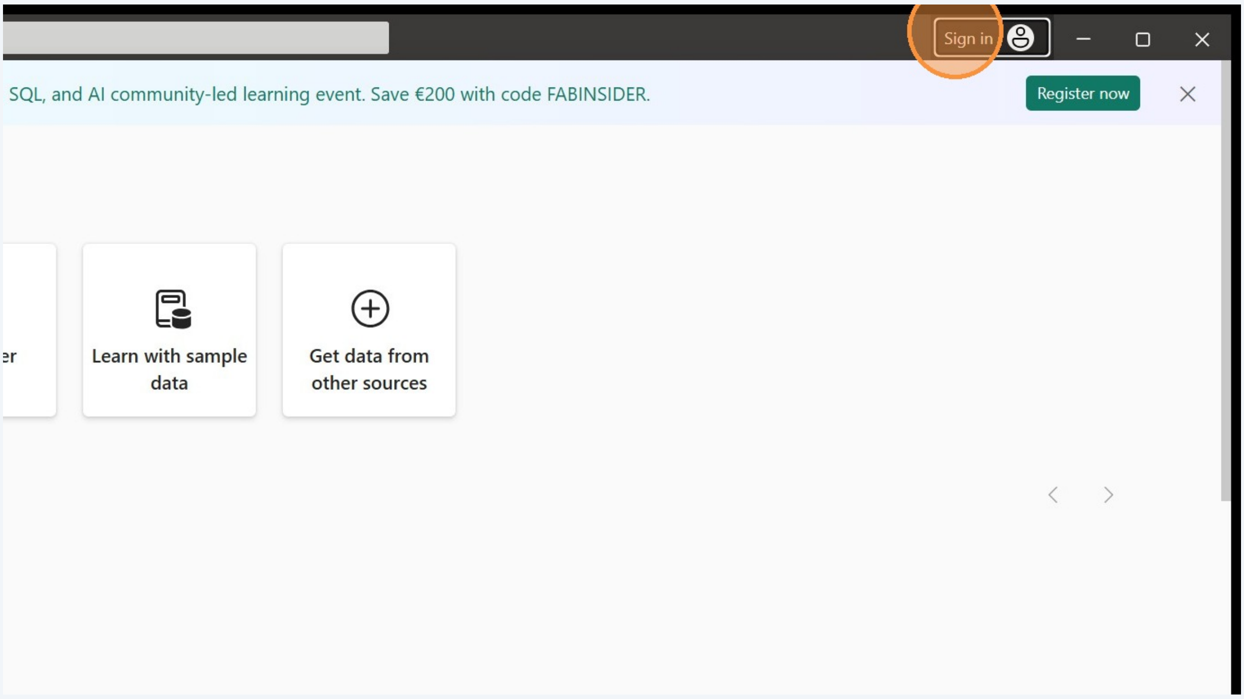
Training.tips

Use this option if you have Power BI desktop installed. We cannot yet create DirectQuery mode models in the browser, so we'll create our connections in desktop and then publish them for further editing in the browser.

Sign in to Power BI Desktop

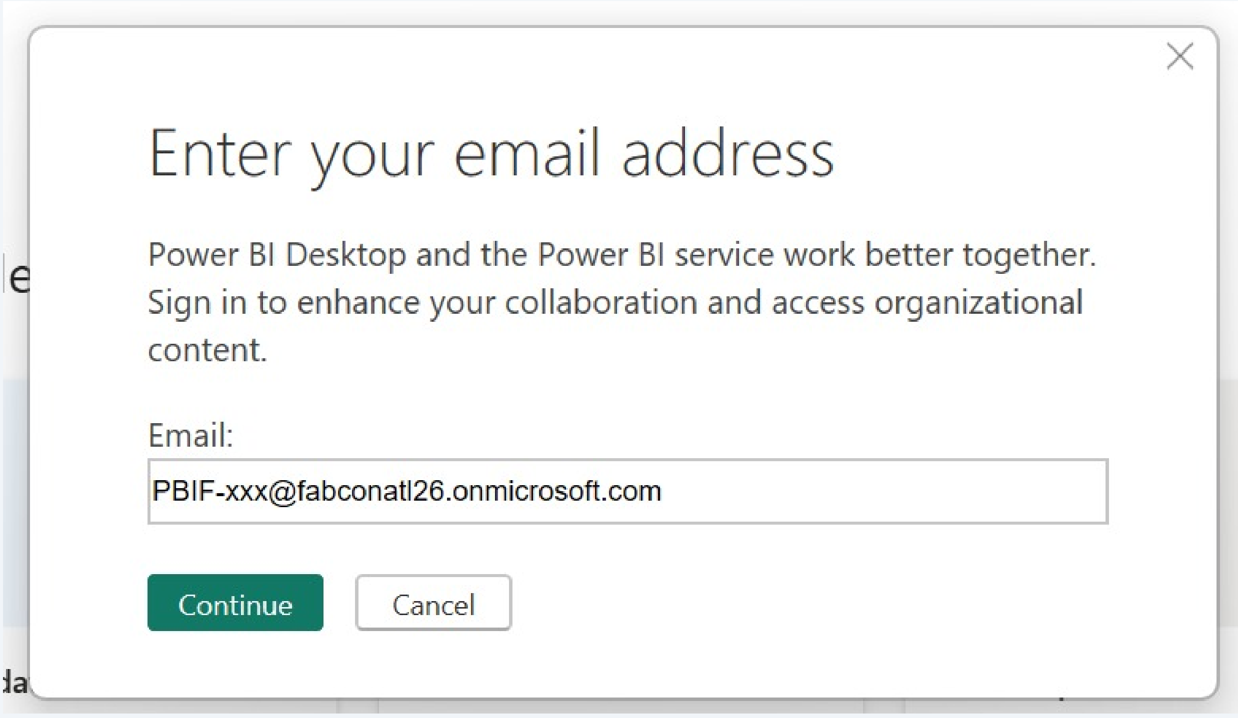
To connect to our workshop workspace, we need to be logged into Power BI desktop with our temporary workshop accounts, not our regular work accounts.

1 Open Power BI desktop and click "Sign in". If you're already signed in with another account, click on your profile image to show the dropdown and select "Sign in with a different account."



2

Enter your workshop email address and click "Continue". You'll have to enter your email address one more time and then the password.



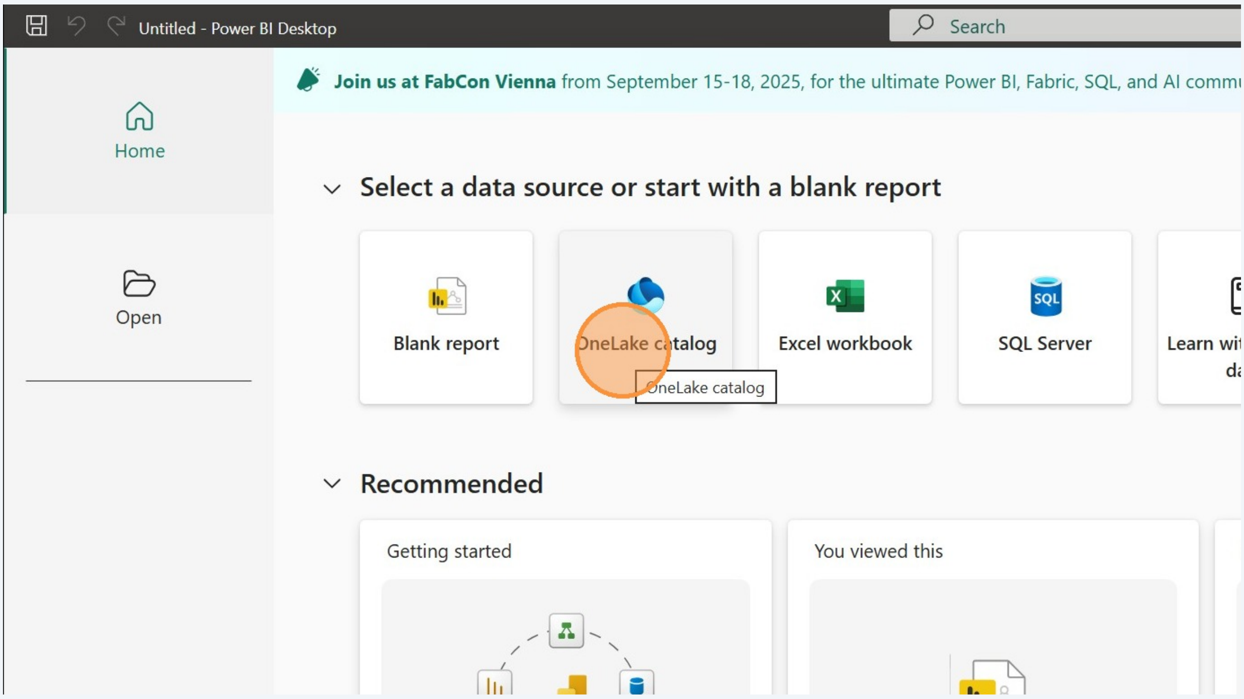
Connect to your lakehouse - Import mode

Tip! if you didn't have time to complete the dataflows lab to land your transformed data into your lakehouse, you can import from a shared lakehouse. Skip this section and move to the next section and import all **six** tables from the shared lakehouse.

3 We'll start by getting data from the lakehouse.

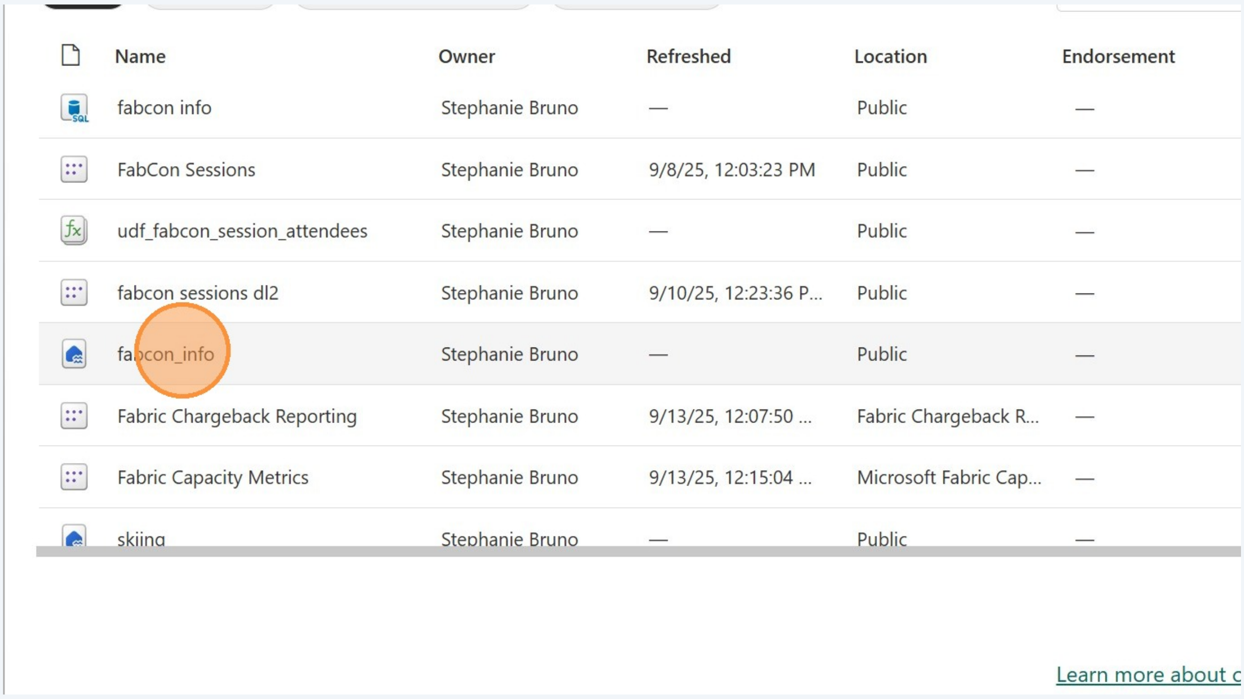
Click the "OneLake catalog" button.

If you're already in the Power BI canvas, there is a OneLake catalog button in the Home tab of the ribbon. Both buttons take us to the same place.



4

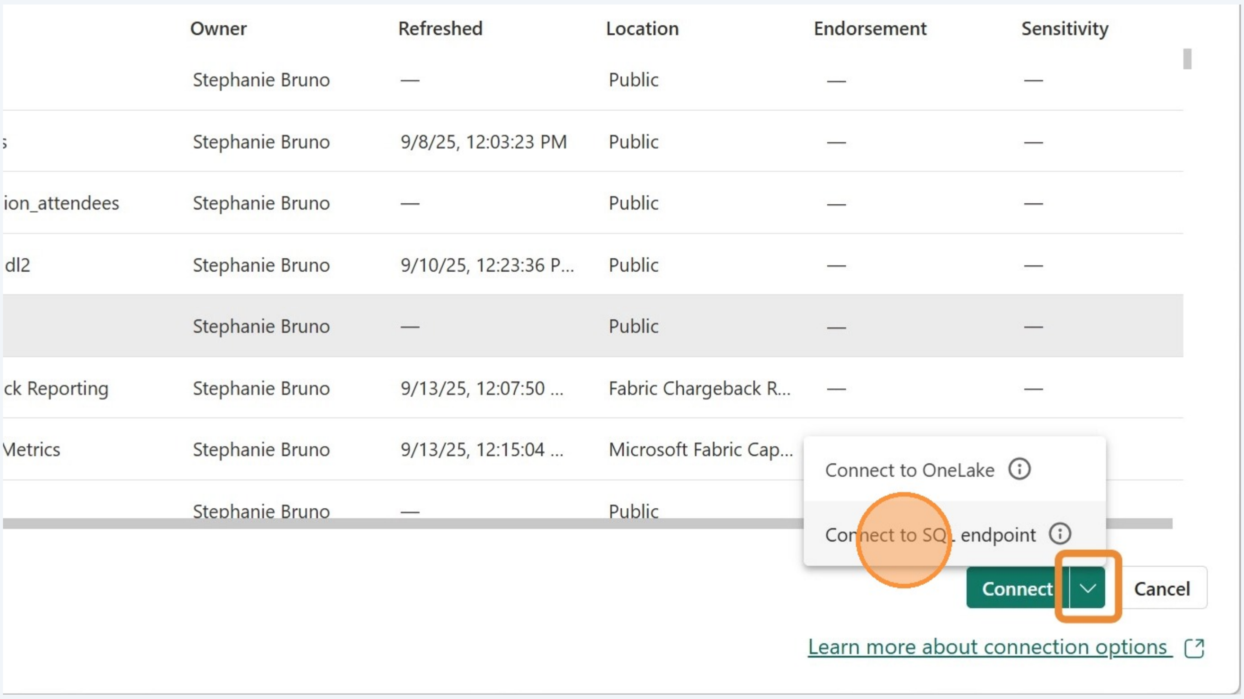
Navigate to your **lakehouse** in your workspace and click the name of the **lakehouse**. This window doesn't have a column to tell you what type of object each item is, but if you hover over the icon it will tell you.



Alert! On the next step, do not click the "Connect" button, rather click the down arrow next to the "Connect" button.

5

Don't just click the big green Connect button, because then you'll connect in Direct Lake mode. We want to import this data today. Click the down arrow next to the Connect button and then select "Connect to SQL endpoint."

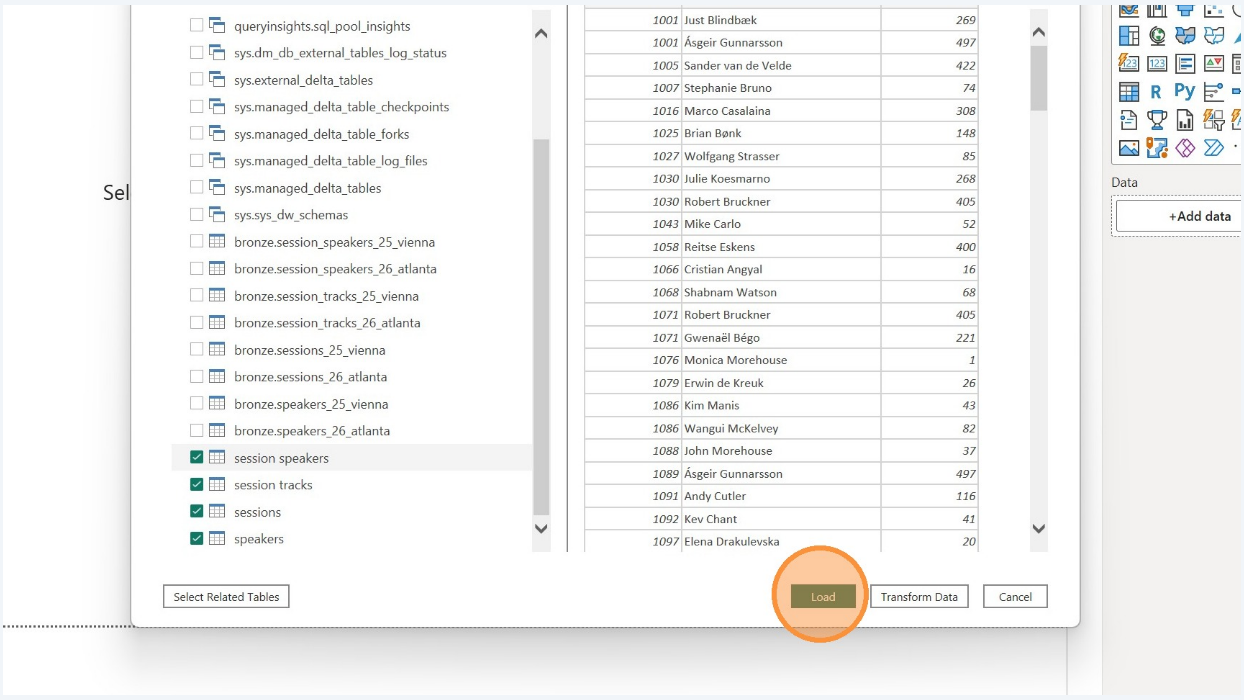


Tip! After clicking Connect, you may get an additional pop-up login that will take you to the browser. If so, go through the additional authentication.

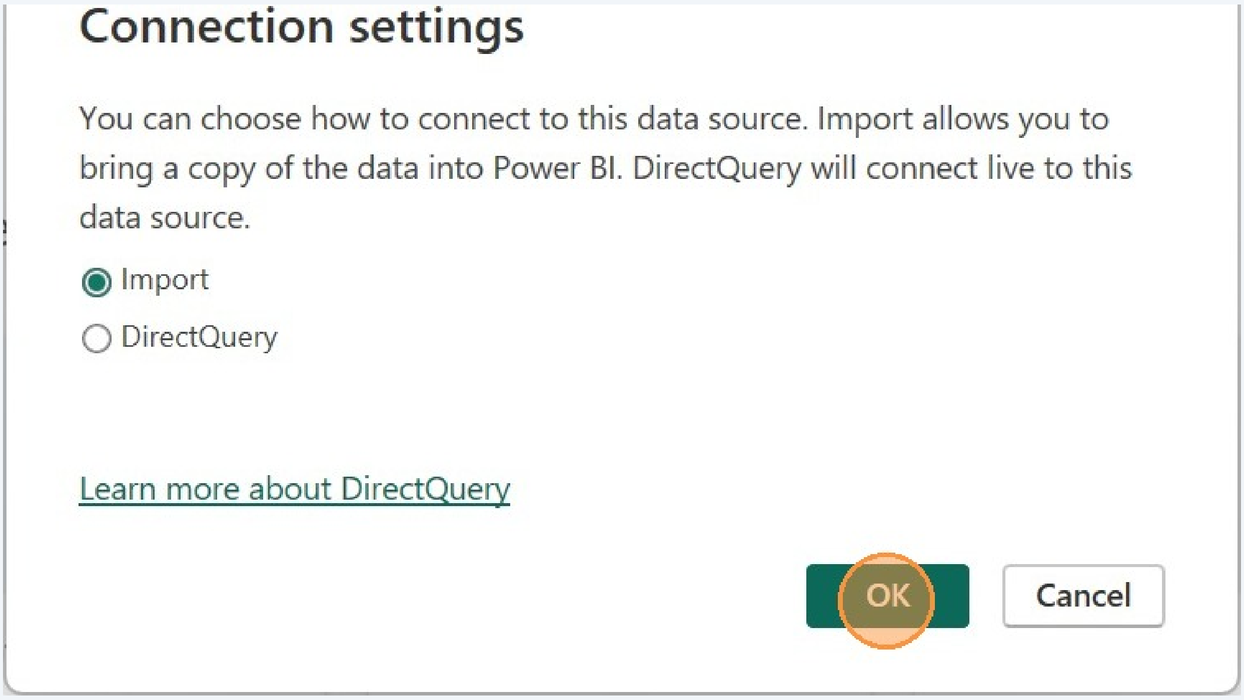
6

Check the boxes next to the four tables you created:

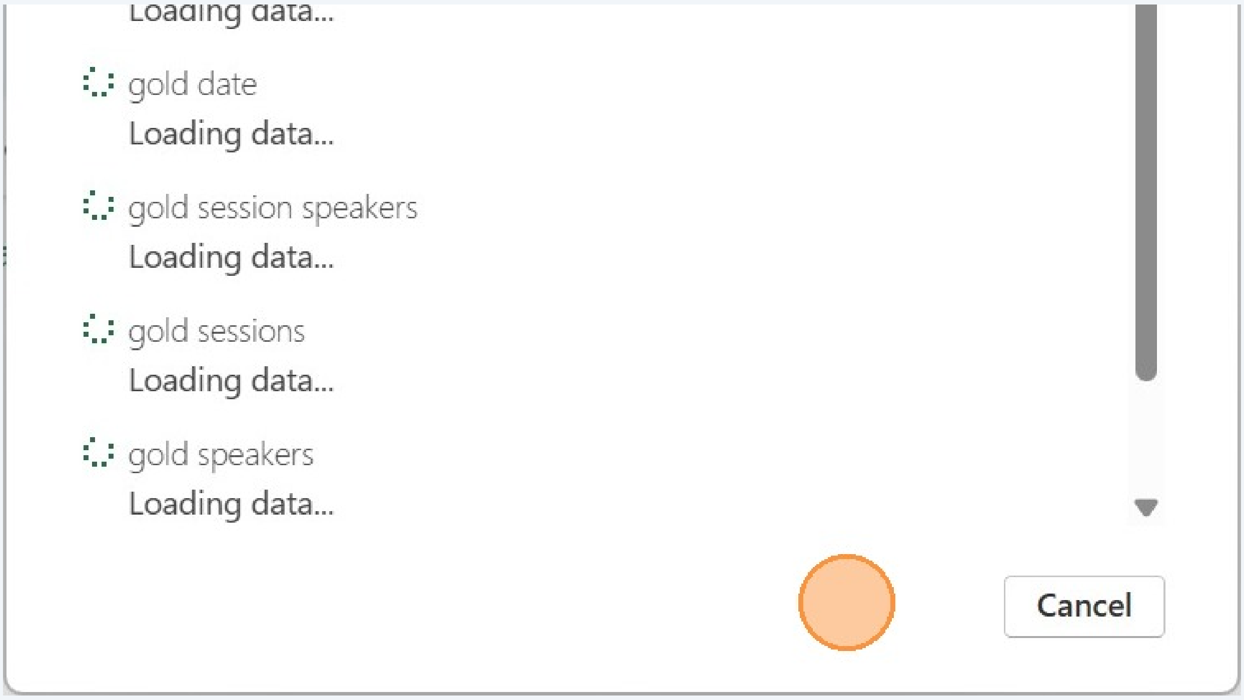
- session speakers
- session tracks
- sessions
- speakers



7 Leave this checked as "Import" and click the "OK" button.



8 Notice the data being imported. Wait for this to finish.



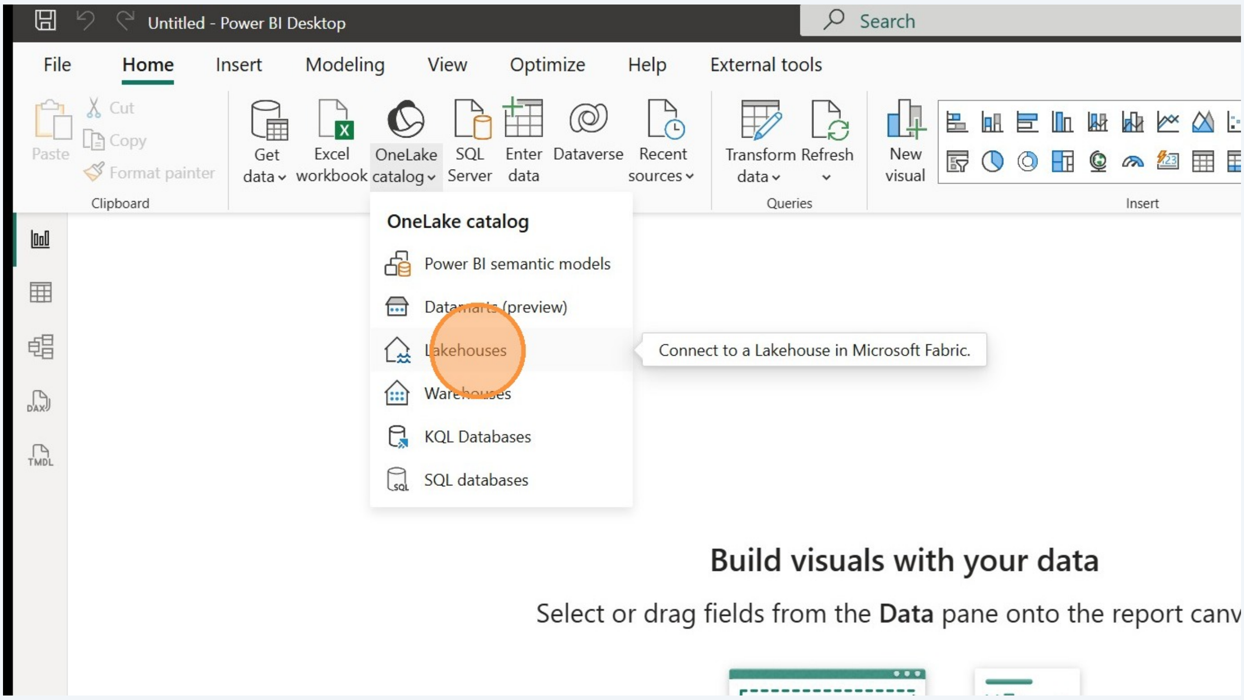
Connect to the shared lakehouse - Import mode

Tip! If you weren't able to get all the way through the Dataflows lab to get your four tables created, you can use this section to import those tables from the shared lakehouse instead.

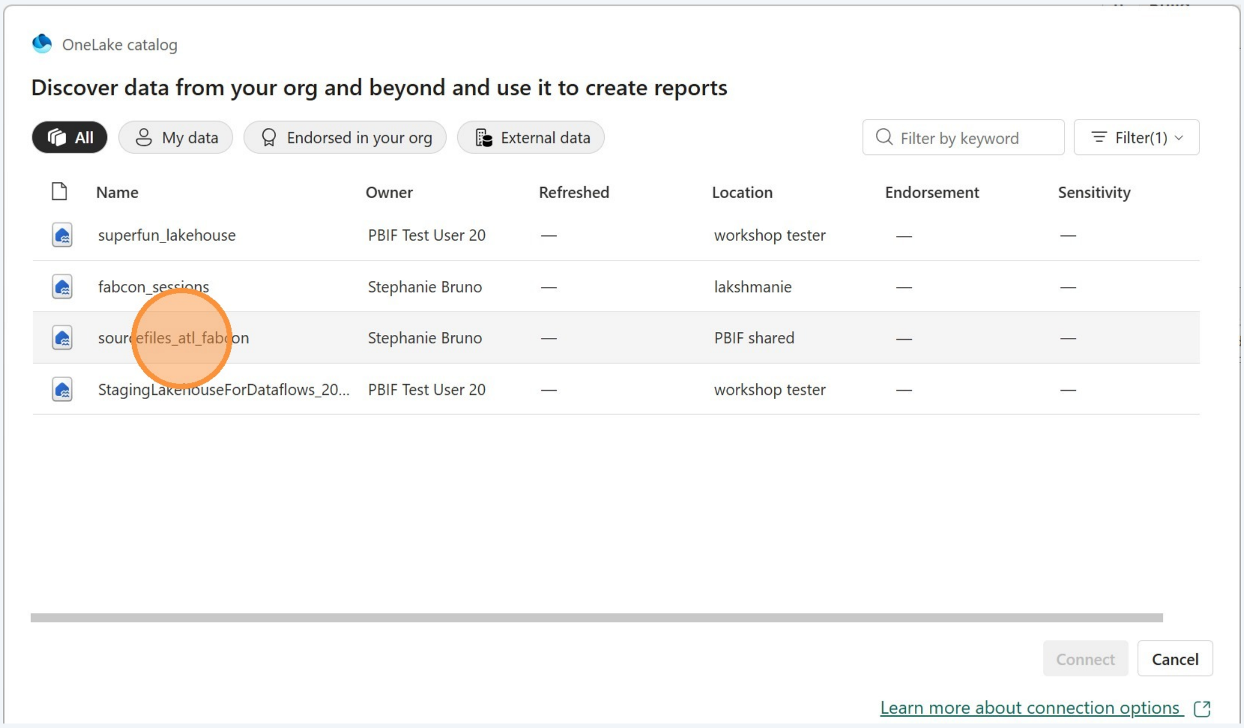
9

There are two tables that our colleagues have created that we would like to use as well. We can simply import from their lakehouse instead of shortcutting.

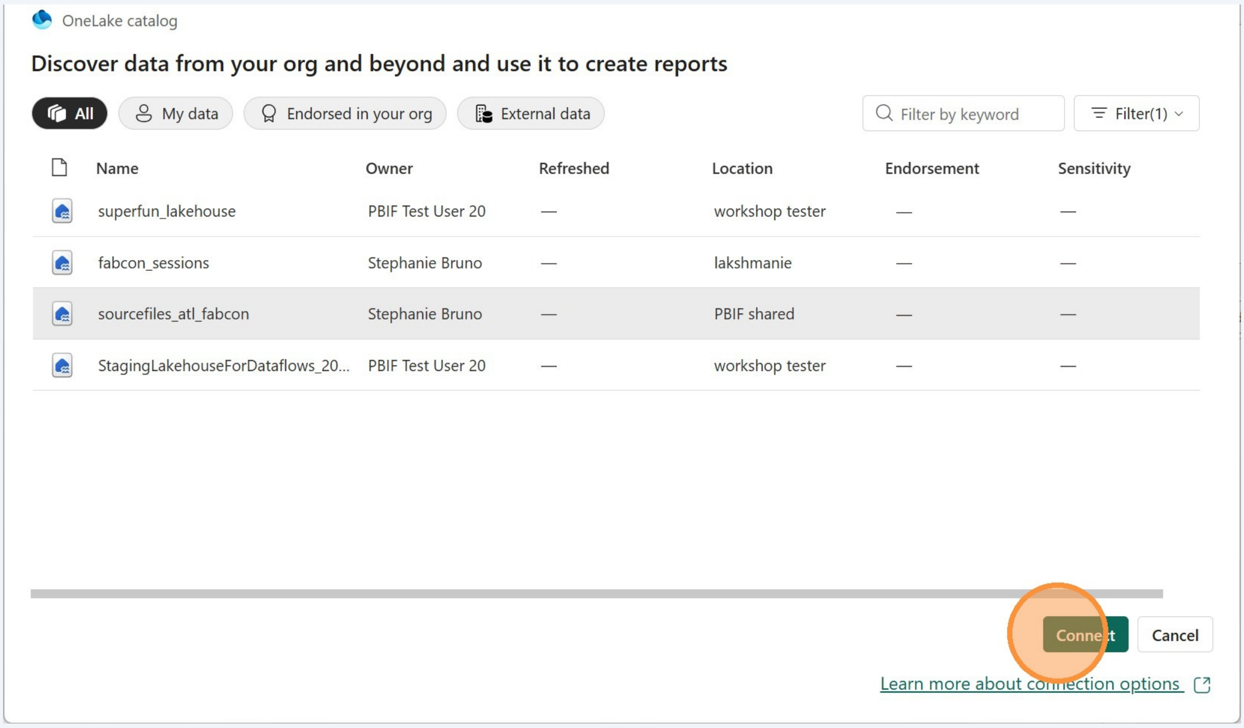
Click the down arrow on the "OneLake catalog" button and select "Lakehouses."



10 Select the "sourcefiles_atl_fabcon" lakehouse.

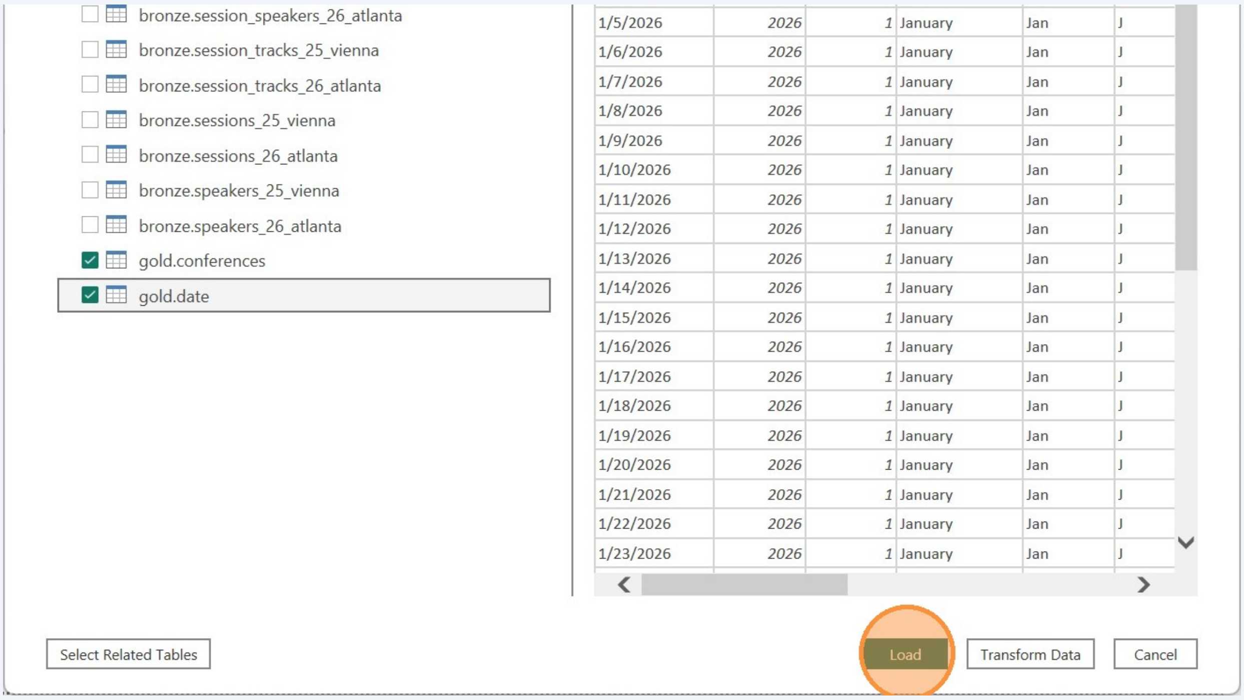


11 Click "Connect"



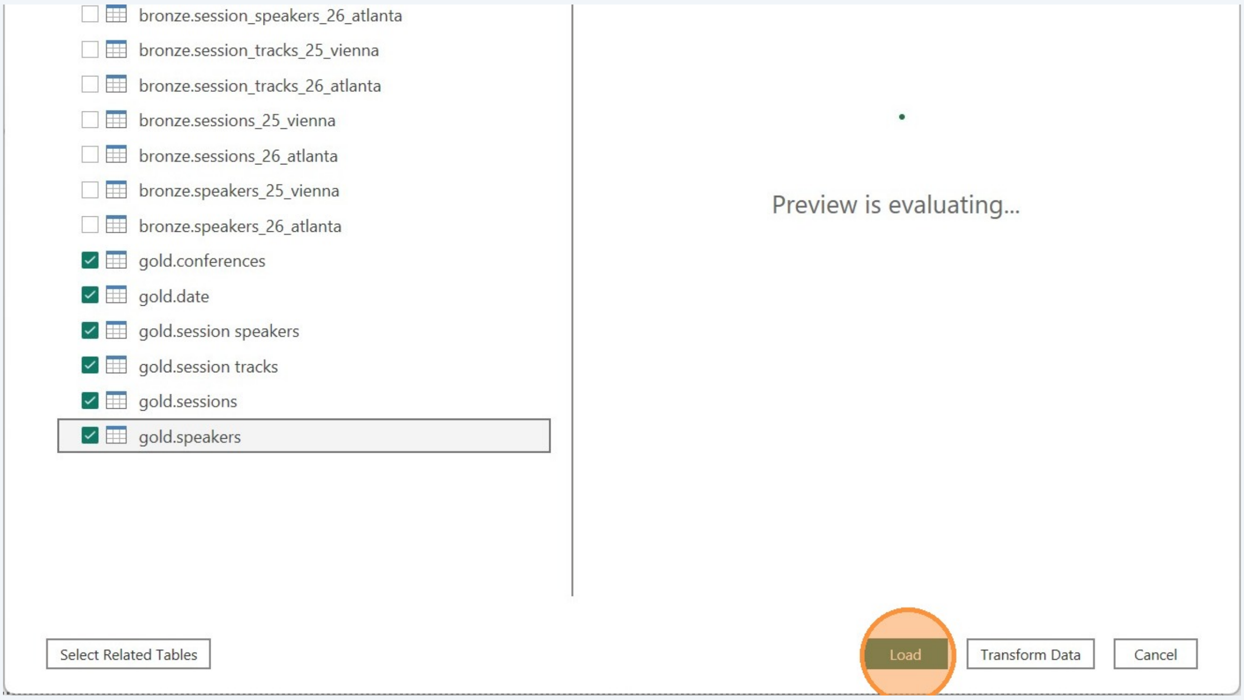
12 **OPTION 1**: Use this if you were able to complete the Dataflow lab and have your four tables in your lakehouse.

Check the **two** checkboxes next to both the gold.conferences and gold.date table and click "Load."

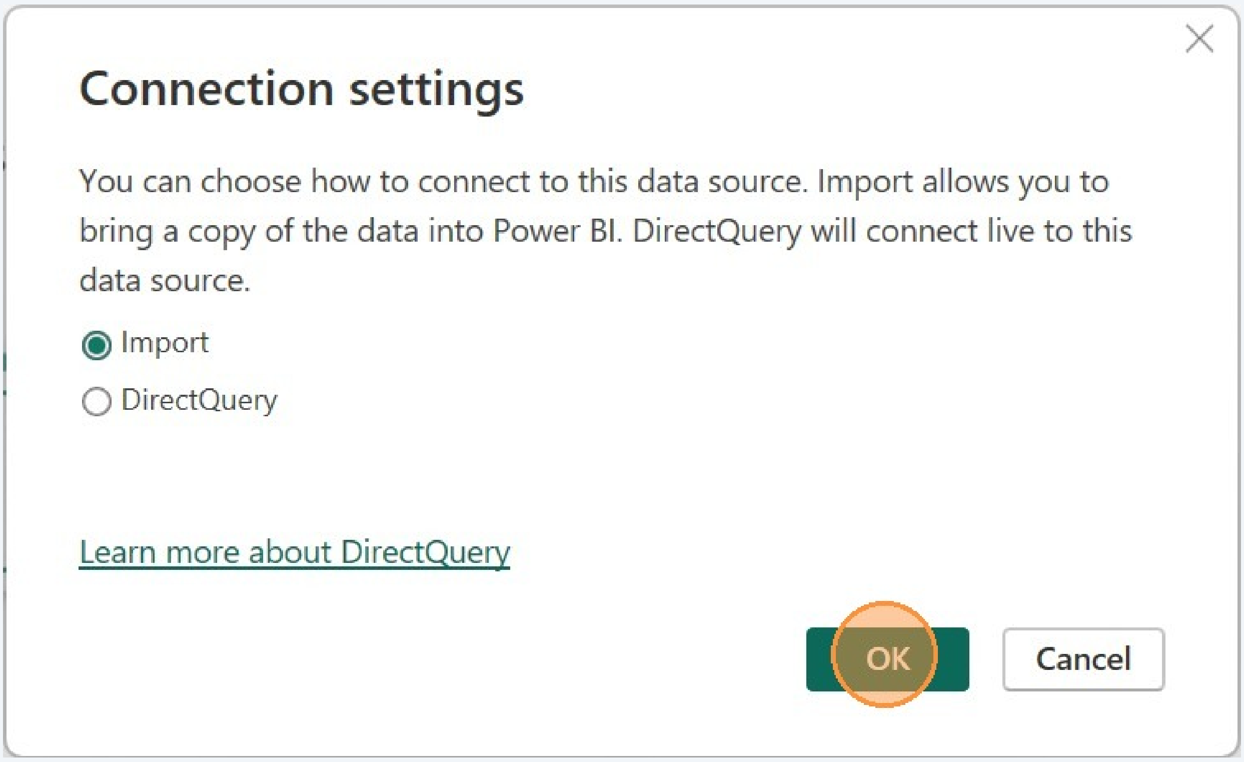


13 **OPTION 2**: Use this if you were **not** able to complete the Dataflow lab and do not have your four tables in your lakehouse. You can use these instead.

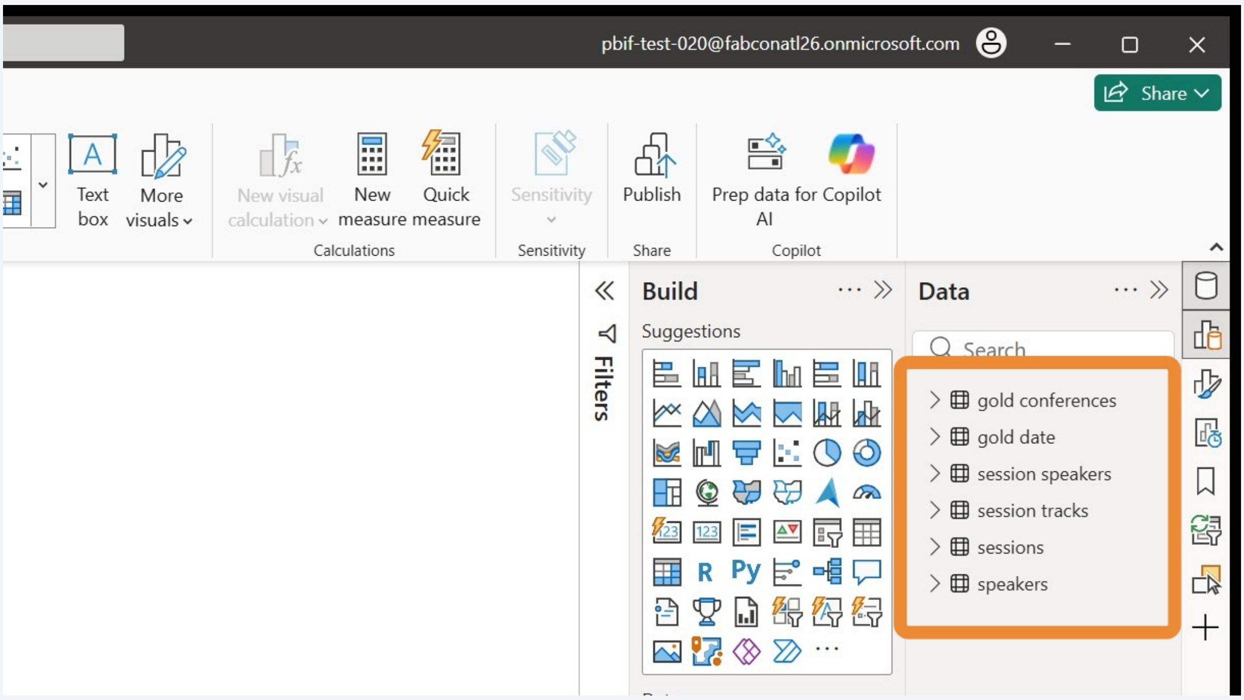
Check the checkboxes next to the **six** "gold." tables and click "Load."



14 Leave the default "Import" selected and click "OK."

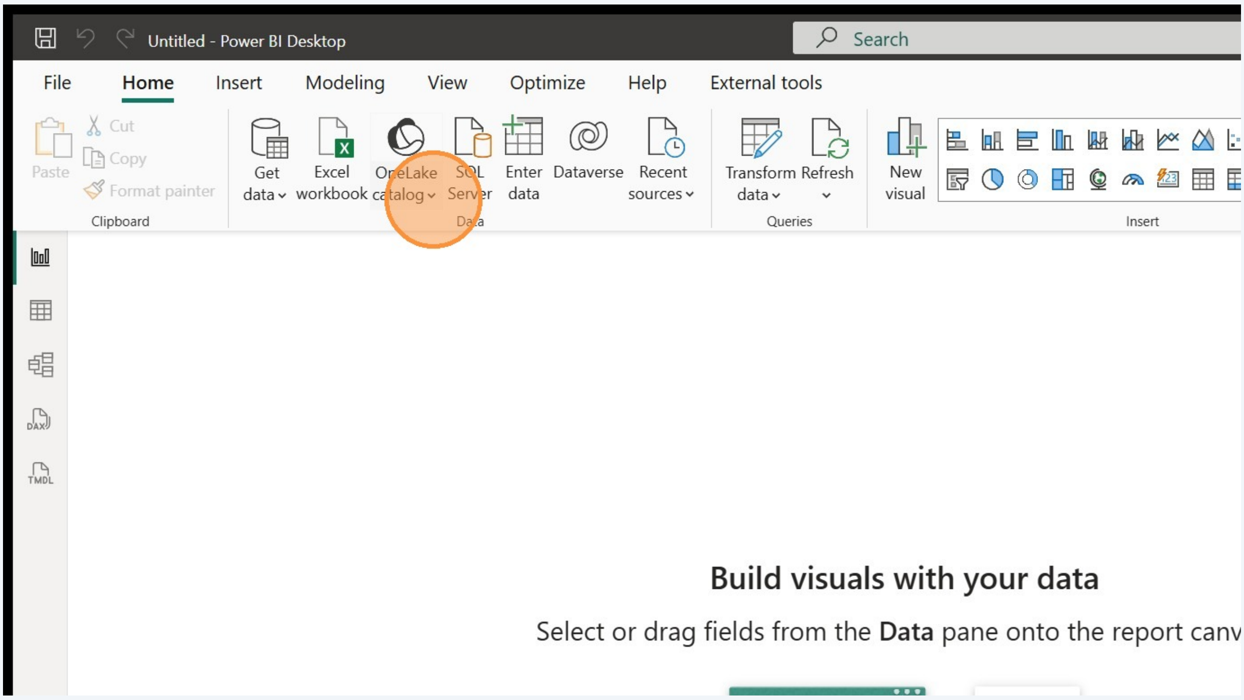


15 You should now have six tables loaded. They may or may not have a "gold " prefix. Either way is fine and we'll clean up the table names in a bit.

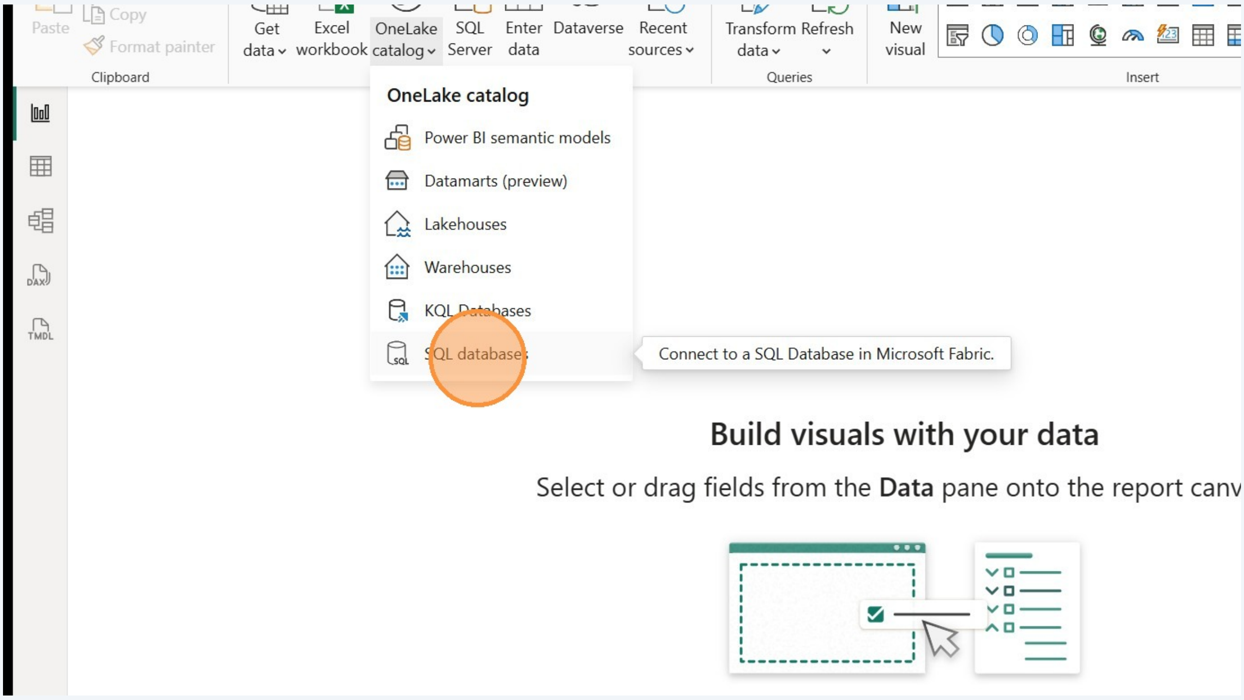


Connect to the SQL database - DirectQuery mode

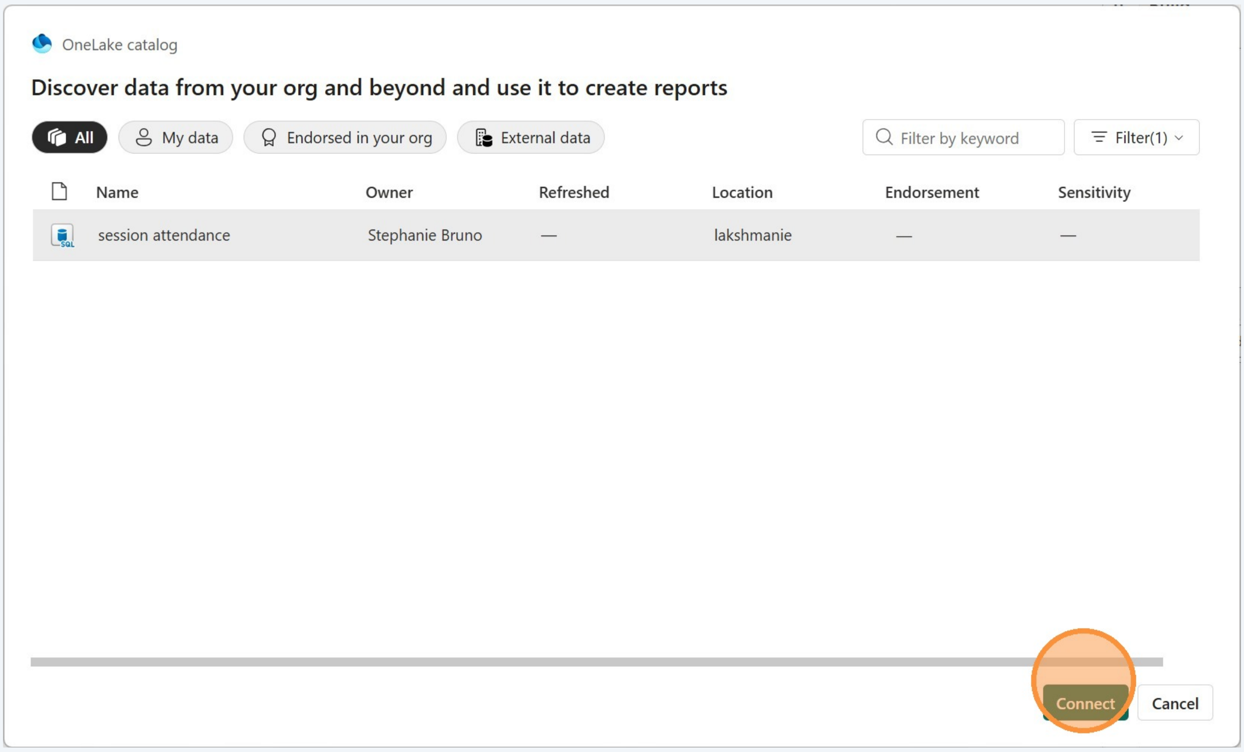
16 Now we'll get the attendees table from the SQL database. Click the **down arrow** next to "One Lake catalog" button in the Home tab (If you accidentally click the button instead, you'll just get a longer list of Fabric items to choose from, which is fine).



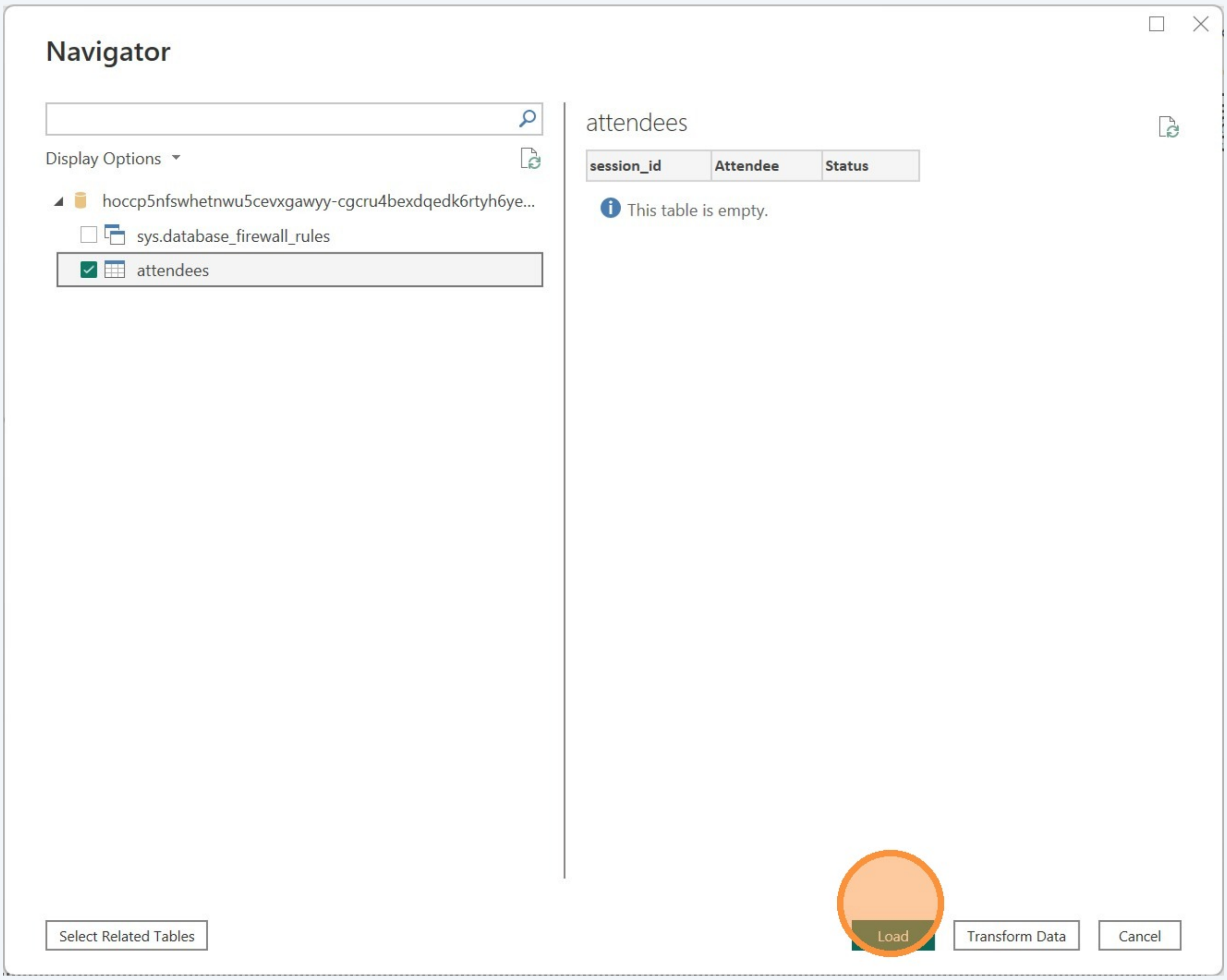
17 Choose "SQL databases." This will make it easier to find what you're looking for, especially if you have created a lot of items in Fabric.



18 Now navigate to your SQL database and click it to select it. Click the "Connect" button.

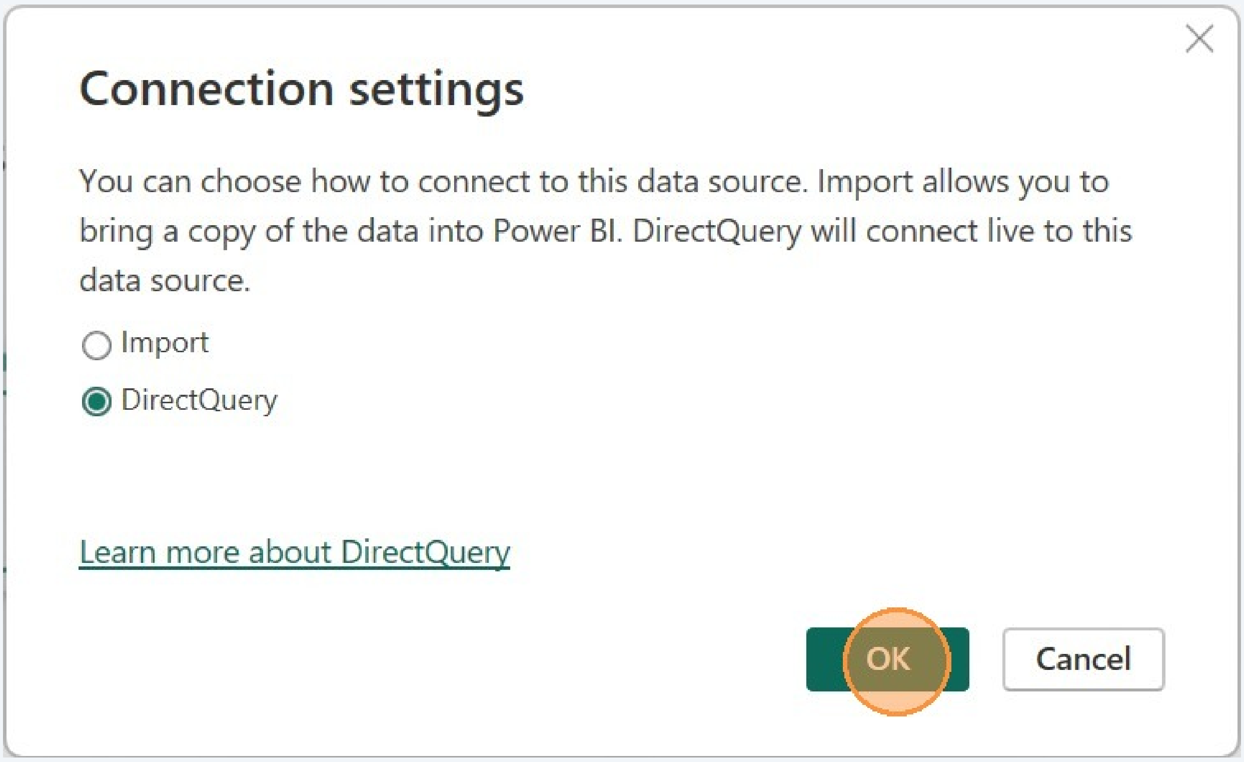


19 Check the box next to the "attendees" table and click the "Load" button.

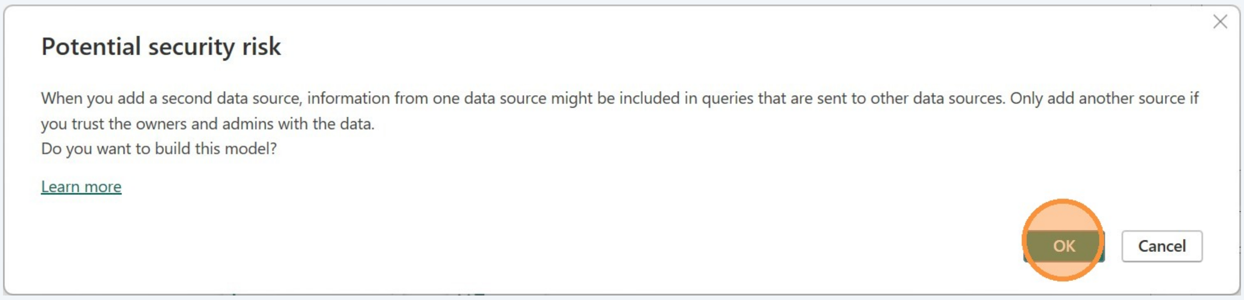


Alert! Make sure to choose DirectQuery for the next step.
This lets us see the results of our write-back functionality right away in the report, without requiring a refresh of the model. If you accidentally choose import, delete the table and reconnect in DirectQuery mode.

20 For this table, we want the mode to be "DirectQuery" so we can do our write-back and have the updates automatically show in the report. Click "DirectQuery" and then the "OK" button.

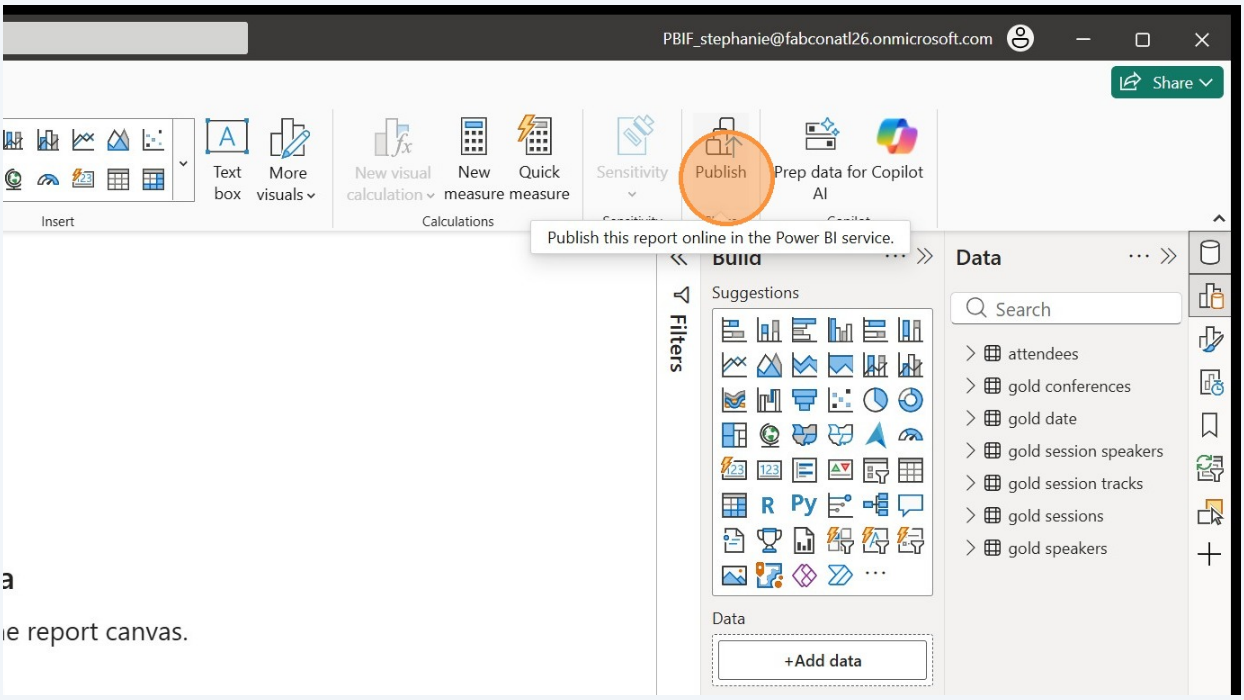


21 This message is letting you know that you have two different data sources that could potentially share data. Click "OK"



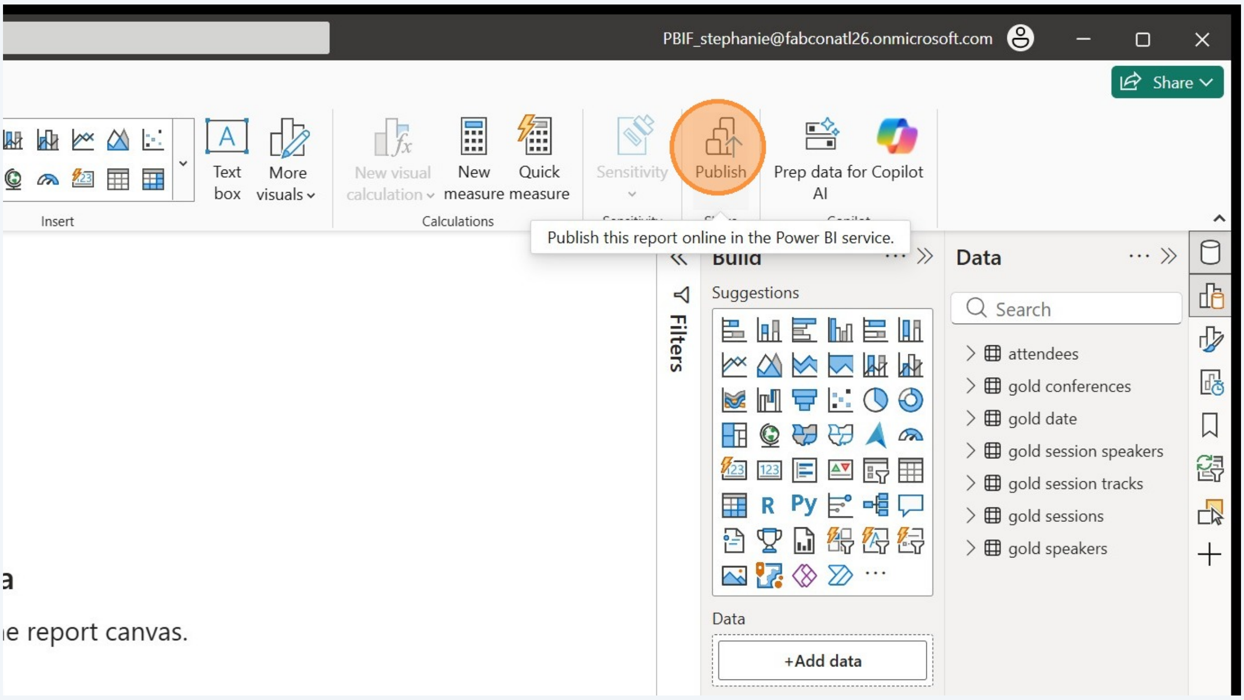
Publish to Fabric

22 Now we have seven tables in a new model. We'll publish it to the Power BI service before making any more changes. Click the "Publish" button.

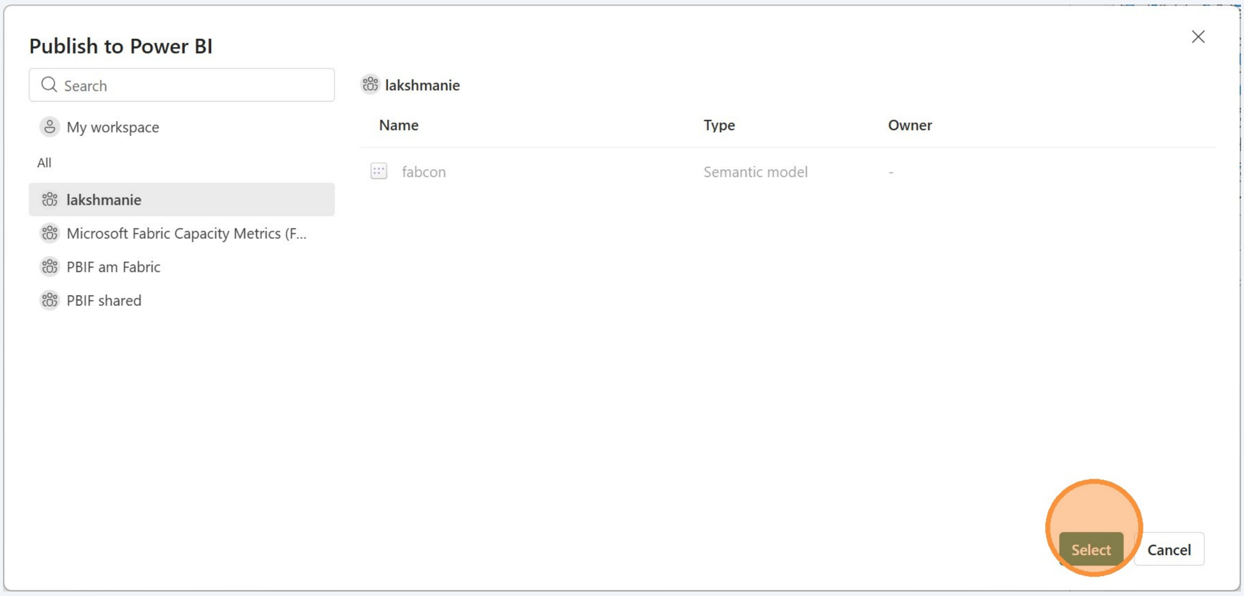


23 When you get a message asking you to Save the file, click the "Save" button and select a location.

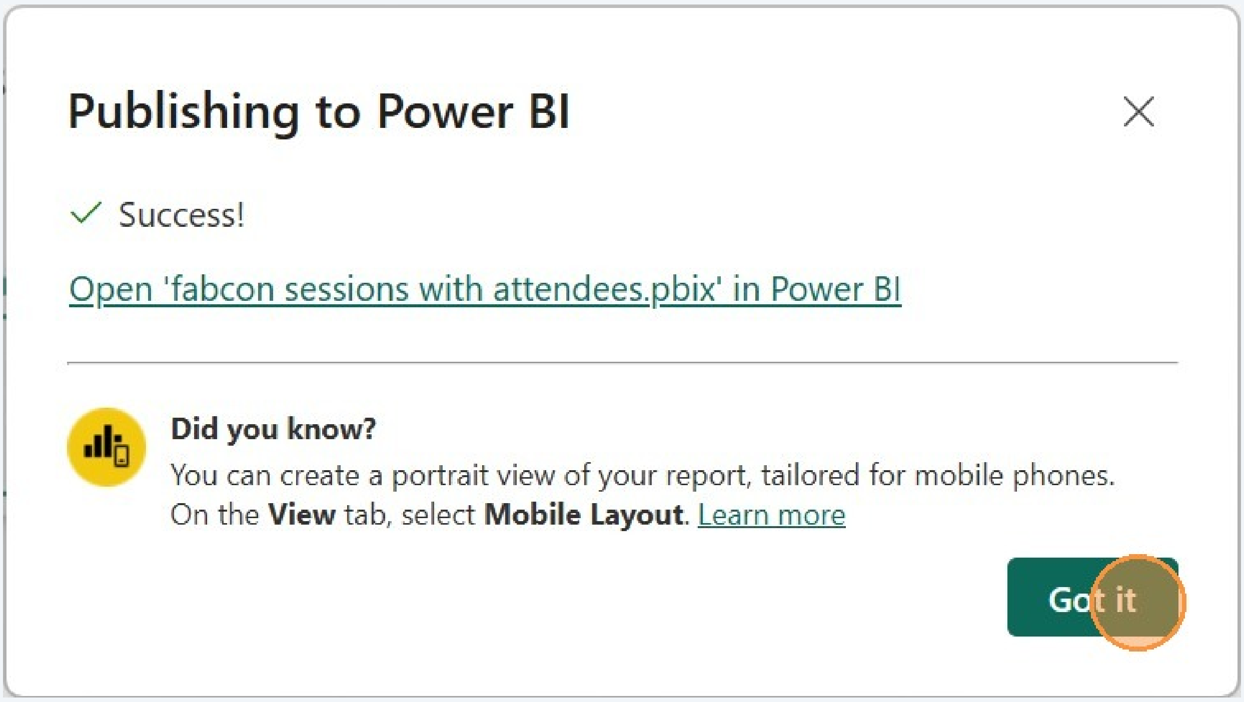
24 If the Publish window doesn't automatically pop up after you save the file, click the Publish button again.



25 Navigate to your workspace and click it, then click the "Select" button. This is where the model will be published.



26 Click "Got it"



27 Great! Now we have a starter semantic model published to the workspace. We'll continue to edit it in the workspace. We're finished with Power BI desktop now so you can close it if you like.